

GOVERNED AI

What AI may never decide

The line the PCI Standards draw, and why it is drawn there.

The principle

AI proposes; the professional verifies, decides and remains accountable.

Every standard in the suite states both halves: what AI may assist with, and what it must never do.

AI may

Draft. Extract. Classify. Detect. Forecast. Summarise. Surface an exception a human would have taken a week to find.

AI must not

Decide. Approve. Certify. Sign. Waive. Authorise.

Or be represented as having independently verified anything.

Why the line sits there

Accountability attaches to a person. A credential guarantees nothing if the holder can point at a model when the number turns out wrong.

"Review the *AI* output" is not verification

Verification names a method: independent recomputation, source tracing, clause-to-summary comparison, sampling on a stated basis, reconciliation, boundary testing, sensitivity analysis.

The trap

Re-running the same tool is not an independent check. Neither is a reviewer confirming their own work.

The standards close both routes explicitly.

PCI STANDARDS

AI earns its place by being checkable

Not by being confident.

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